TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Give a Progress Update on a Task or Project

Narrate | PPF | Timeline Reconstruction

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Give a clear progress update: what you have done, where things are now, what happens next, and what is still open.

WHO	Three weeks ago your manager, Mr. Tan, asked you to clean up the customer contact list (about 900 contacts).
SITUATION	It is Monday morning. In the team meeting, Mr. Tan asks how the list is going. He first asked for it by last Friday. He has five minutes and wants to know if it will be ready for the newsletter.
NEED	He needs the update in order: what is done, what you are doing now, what comes next — and anything you need from him.
GOAL	Give an organised update (Past → Present → Future) and say clearly what is still open.

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mr. Tan asks: "Morning. Can you give me a quick update on the customer list?" Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Ali's answer. Mark where each part starts.

Three weeks ago, Mr. Tan asked me to clean up our customer list of about 900 contacts. So far, I've checked 600 of them and removed the duplicates. At the moment, I'm checking the last 300 and calling the customers with no email address. There are still about 80 calls to go. I'm going to finish the calls by Friday. After that, I'll send you the final list, and then we can use it for the newsletter. One thing is still open: some customers have already changed company, so I need your decision this week on whether to keep them.

P PAST · WHAT IS DONE

P PRESENT · WHERE WE ARE NOW

F FUTURE · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

! STILL OPEN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Mei Ling updates Mr. Tan on the new invoice template: done → now → next → still open.

- [ ] Last week I finished the new invoice design and sent it to the accounts team.
- [ ] One thing to note: two customers still want paper invoices, so I need to know if that's okay.
- [ ] Next Monday, I'll fix any problems, and then we can switch every customer to the new template.
- [ ] Right now, we're testing it with five customers.

Write the letter: **P** = Past · what is done · **P** = Present · where we are now · **F** = Future · what happens next · **!** = Still open

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

PAST · WHAT IS DONE

- [ ] Three weeks ago, I started …
- [ ] So far, I've …
- [ ] Last week, we finished …
- [ ] I've already …

PRESENT · WHERE WE ARE NOW

- [ ] At the moment, I'm …
- [ ] Right now, we're …
- [ ] There are still … to go.
- [ ] We're on track.

FUTURE · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

- [ ] Next, I'm going to …
- [ ] By Friday, I'll …
- [ ] After that, …
- [ ] Then we can …

STILL OPEN

- [ ] One thing to note: …
- [ ] I need your decision on …
- [ ] The only problem is …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. I checked the contacts. [but / because / First … then …] I removed the duplicates.

_____

2. I'll finish the calls by Friday. [After that, / For example, / However,] I'll send you the list.

_____

3. Some customers have changed company. [so / then / but] I need your decision.

_____

4. Most of the list is done. [but / because / so] About 80 contacts still have no email address.

_____

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. Three weeks ago I _____ the clean-up. (A finished step, with a time)
   - ○ have started
   - ○ start
   - ○ started
2. So far, I _____ 600 contacts. (What is done so far, no exact time)
   - ○ have checked
   - ○ am checked
   - ○ have check
3. At the moment, I _____ the customers with no email address. (What is happening right now)
   - ○ calling
   - ○ am calling
   - ○ am call
4. I _____ finish the calls by Friday. (A plan)
   - ○ was
   - ○ have
   - ○ am going to

SLIDE 09 Present Perfect for 'so far'

When you say what is done up to now, without an exact time, use have / has + past participle. Add so far, already, not yet.

So far, I**'ve checked** 600 contacts.

We**'ve already removed** the duplicates.

I **haven't called** everyone **yet**.

Some customers **have changed** company.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

P

PAST · DONE

… ago, I started … So far, I've …

P

PRESENT · NOW

At the moment, I'm …

F

FUTURE · NEXT

Next, I'm going to … By …, I'll …

!

STILL OPEN

One thing to note: …

SLIDE 11 Timeline Reconstruction

The speaker gives an update from a mixed-up card. The listener cannot see the card: they write the timeline in order and ask what is needed.

1. Round 1 (3:00). Speaker: your card has the facts mixed up. Give the update in order: done → now → next → still open.
2. Listener: no card. Fill in the listener's note in your workbook, then ask: 'When will it be ready?' 'What do you need?'
3. Round 2 (2:00): listeners move one seat. Same update to the new listener, shorter. Listeners use the next column.
4. Round 3 (1:00), frames closed: speakers turn the workbook over. Swap roles: rounds 1–3 again, on your own task.

Card 1 · New company website

Card 2 · Office move

Card 3 · Staff training

Listener's note: the update

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Done (in order)			
Now			
Next, and when?			
Still open / needed			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. Why is it taking longer than planned?
2. Can you finish it by Wednesday instead of Friday?
3. What happens if some customers don't answer the phone?

Start with: **The reason is that … · I can try, but … · If that happens, I'll …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

A friend asks how your fitness plan (or your home renovation) is going. Give an update: what you have done, what you are doing now, what is next.

Two months ago I started … · So far, I've … · Right now, I'm … · Next, I'm going to …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Events come in a clear order: done → now → next.
- [ ] Uses time words (ago, so far, at the moment, by Friday).
- [ ] Says clearly what is still open or needed.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Clear order (past → now → next)	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Time words	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Saying what is still open	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

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After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · New company website

You are Mr. Tan. Write the website timeline in the right order. Then ask: When can customers use it? Do you need anything from me?

Card 2 · Office move

You are Mr. Tan. Write the office move in the right order, from the first step to the last. Then ask: Which day is it? Is anything still open?

Card 3 · Staff training

You are Siti from HR. Write the training plan in the right order. Then ask: How many people are coming? Is there anything I should know?

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · New company website

Need: team photos · Testing on phones: now · Started: 6 weeks ago · Go live: after the fixes · Done: home page, product pages · Fix problems: by Friday

Card 2 · Office move

Set up the internet: after the move · Found the new office: 2 months ago · Packing files: now · Question: who keeps the old keys? · Move: on the 15th · Done: signed the contract, ordered furniture

Card 3 · Staff training

Problem: two people are on leave on the 20th · Collecting replies: now (12 of 20) · Chose the course: 1 month ago · Confirm the room: next week · Training: on the 20th · Done: booked the trainer, sent the invitations